

Shijia Qing

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EDUCATION

Sun Yat-sen University
M.A. in Applied Psychology
GPA: 3.88/4

Guangzhou, China
Jun 2026 (expected)

Relevant courses: Special Topics on Human Factor (94/100), Machine Learning and Its Applications in User Behaviour Analytics (95/100), Advanced Statistical Methods in Psychology (89/100), Special Topics on Social Psychology (91.5/100)

Sun Yat-sen University
B.A. in Spanish Literature
GPA: 3.80/4

Zhuhai, China
Jun 2023

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social Cognition, Uncanny Valley, Perception of Humanoid Robot

PUBLICATIONS

Journal paper

- **Shijia Qing**, Hongwei Cai, & Guomei Zhou. Unraveling Group Attractiveness: Weighted Averaging and Recency Effects in RSVP Presentations. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: Human Perception and Performance*. (under reviewed)

Manuscripts

- The Effects of Cosmetic Surgery Labels on Perceptions of Facial Attractiveness and Naturalness: The Role of Mate Selection and Attitudes.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **Shijia Qing**, Hongwei Cai, & Guomei Zhou. Recency Effect in the Ensemble Perception of Average Facial Attractiveness. 2024 Annual Conference of the Division of General and Experimental Psychology, Chinese Psychological Society. Lanzhou, China. March, 2024.
- **Shijia Qing**, Ying Lin, & Guomei Zhou. The Role of Social Familiarity and Self in the Uncanny Valley Effect: An Exploration of Multidimensional Mechanisms. 2025 Annual Conference of the Chinese Association of Social Psychology. Chengdu, China. June, 2025 (expected).

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Research on Social Familiarity and Self in the Uncanny Valley: A Multidimensional Exploration (Master thesis)

Author & Researcher | Advisor: Prof. Guomei Zhou

December 2024 — Present

- This project investigates the uncanny valley effect through the lens of social cognition and self-concept, focusing on emotional, cognitive, and social mechanisms.
- Designed and implemented experiments manipulating variables such as human-likeness, familiarity, and self-referential stimuli to test major uncanny valley hypotheses.
- Developed a multidimensional framework of social familiarity and analyzed its interactions with emotional and social-cognitive processes using data visualization and modeling techniques.
- Proposed future expansions, including the application of machine learning models to simulate UV-related emotional responses and the use of Virtual Reality technologies to explore real-time human-AI interactions.

The Role of Self-Concept in Shaping the Uncanny Valley: A Meta-Analytic Approach (In progress)

Researcher | Advisor: Prof. Guomei Zhou

March 2025 — Present

- This project explores how self-concept perception influences the depth and position of the uncanny valley effect through a systematic meta-analysis of studies on individual psychological traits and emotional responses to near-human artificial entities.
- Conducted literature review and study selection based on defined criteria.
- Extracted and coded data for meta-analytic statistical analysis.

- Interpreted results and contributed to the theoretical framework and report preparation.

Development and Validation of the Scale of Human Threat Perception and Defensive Mechanisms Toward Robots (In progress)

Researcher | Advisor: Prof. Guomei Zhou

April 2025 — Present

- This project focuses on developing and validating a scale that measures human perceptions of threat and defensive responses toward robots, with a focus on emotional, cognitive, and behavioral dimensions.
- Conducted an extensive literature review to refine the theoretical framework and identify key constructs of the scale.
- Analyzed the scale's reliability and validity using exploratory factor analysis (EFA) and confirmatory factor analysis (CFA).

Customer Subscription Prediction for Bank Products Based on the LightGBM Model

Author & Researcher | Advisor: Associate Prof. Ying Lin

October 2024 — January 2025

- Preprocessed data (feature encoding, standardization, dataset splitting), optimized machine learning models (Decision Tree, Random Forest, XGBoost, LightGBM) using Optuna, and evaluated their performance; analyzed feature importance using LightGBM.
- Visualized results and contributed to final report preparation, highlighting key findings and actionable insights.

INTERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Seasun Games Co., Ltd.

Zhuhai, China

User Experience Engineer (Third-Person-Perspective Mecha Shooting Game)

Oct 2022 — Jun 2023

- **User Experience Research:** Conducted player interviews, playtests, and surveys to analyze behavior, emotional needs, and engagement; created user personas to guide game design and development.
- **Game Scenario Design:** Evaluated gameplay mechanics, combat systems, art style, and monetization strategies; provided actionable insights to enhance game balance and player satisfaction.
- **Offline Testing and Interviews:** Organized and conducted playtests and focus group interviews in US; gathered and analyzed player feedback to support gaming experience optimization.

Netease Interactive Entertainment Co.,Ltd

Guangzhou, China

User Experience Engineer (Strategy and Simulation Game)

Jul 2024 — Oct 2024

- **User Experience Research:** Designed and conducted player interviews, surveys, and usability tests to explore player motivations, pain points, and preferences; provided data-driven insights to improve game mechanics and user engagement.
- **Competitive Research:** Performed desk research and benchmarking analysis of similar SLG games, focusing on gameplay mechanics, monetization strategies, and user retention methods; delivered actionable recommendations for product positioning.
- **Offline Testing and Interviews:** Facilitated local playtests and focus group interviews to gather feedback from Chinese players, with a particular emphasis on Three Kingdoms-themed content and Chinese cultural elements.

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- First Prize Scholarship (*top 5%*) Dec 2023
- Second Prize Scholarship (*top 10%*) Dec 2024

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese, English (IELTS: 7.5), Spanish (elementary)
- **Programming Languages:** Matlab, R, Python
- **Software and Tools:** SPSS, LaTeX, Markdown, Excel, Html
- **Interests:** Videogames, Music, Jogging, Hiking